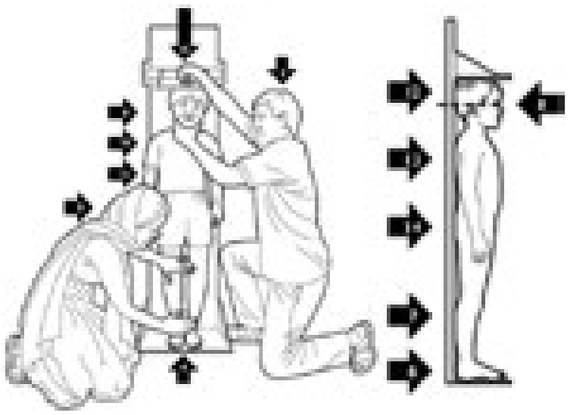
12. While holding the knees, pull the footboard against the child's feet. The soles of the feet should be flat against the footboard, toes pointing upwards.
13. Read the measurement and record the child's length in centimetres to the last completed 0.1 cm. This is the last line that you can actually see. (0.1 cm = 1 mm)
14. Remember: If the child whose length you measured is 2 years old or more, subtract 0.7 cm from the length and record the result as height.

Measurement of Height



1. Mount a stadiometer at a right angle between a level floor and against a straight, vertical surface such as a wall or pillar.
2. Ensure that the height board is on level ground.
3. Remove shoes, socks and hair ornaments from the child.
4. Help the child to stand on the baseboard with feet slightly apart. The back of the head, shoulder blades, buttocks, calves, and heels should touch the vertical board.
5. The trunk should be balanced over the waist, i.e., not leaning back or forward.
6. Ask the mother/helper to hold the child's knees and ankles to help keep the legs straight and feet flat, with heels and calves touching the vertical board.
7. Position the child's head by holding your thumb and forefinger over the child's chin.
8. If necessary, push gently on the tummy to help the child stand to full height.
9. Still keeping the head in position, use your other hand to pull down the headboard to rest firmly on top of the head and compress the hair.
10. Read the measurement and record the child's height in centimetres to the last completed 0.1 cm This is the last line that you can actually see. (0.1 cm = 1 mm)
11. Remember: If the child whose height you measured is less than 2 years old, add 0.7 cm to the height.

Articles required for measuring circumference

- Inch tape / measuring tape
- Marker pen
- Paper for recording.

Measurement of Head Circumference

1. Place light drape or paper on flat surface
2. Place infant/child in supine position or seated on paper drape if the child could sit.
3. Use a measuring tape that cannot be stretched
4. Place tape measure over the most prominent point of the occiput, around the head just above the eyebrows and pinna. This point should be taken as head circumference.
5. Take the measurement to the nearest 0.1 cm



Practical 1-8.indd 312 09-03-2020 15:33:10